

4.3 Language in action

The aim of this area of study is to allow students to explore and analyse language data independently and develop and reflect upon their own writing expertise.

It requires students to carry out two different kinds of individual research:

- a language investigation (2,000 words excluding data)
- a piece of original writing and commentary (750 words each).

Students can choose to pursue a study of spoken, written or multimodal data, or a mixture of text types, demonstrating knowledge in areas of individual interest.

In preparation for this, students need to study how to:

- identify an appropriate investigation topic and research questions
- select and apply a methodology for data collection and analysis
- work in greater depth and with greater range
- transcribe spoken data where appropriate
- use language concepts and ideas
- evaluate and draw conclusions on the findings of the investigation
- present findings in an appropriate and accessible way
- reference reading materials correctly
- evaluate the structures and conventions of a variety of genres
- plan, draft and redraft as part of the writing process
- reflect on the writing process using methods of language analysis.